

Interaction between fluids and Helfrich membranes

Michele Castellana^{1,2}

¹*Institut Curie, PSL Research University, Paris, France*

²*CNRS UMR168, 11 rue Pierre et Marie Curie, 75005, Paris, France*

(Dated: January 10, 2026)

1. [1] study the steady state with arc-length gauge
2. In the dynamics, arc-length gauge does not work
3. We show how to use a generalized arc-length gauge and how to correctly incorporate it into the dynamics to obtain a proper dynamics, Fig. 7.
4. In this dynamics

- we implement the Crank-Nicolson method to the equations written in the reference configuration, and prove it to be numerically stable
- we show that the derivative of mesh motion $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D$ can be obtained exactly from an auxiliary PDE without recurring to error-prone time discretization.

5. We couple the membrane dynamics to a bulk fluid. The membrane is a complex elastic body -; We proceed by steps:

- (a) Bulk fluid + rigid body Fig. 2
- (b) Elastic body with stable elastic model (stable under compression)
- (c) Bulk fluid + elastic body with stable elastic model, Fig. 5
- (d) Bulk fluid + membrane, Fig. 8

- Bulk fluid and membrane both described with Crank-Nicolson method -; we prove that the resulting dynamics is numerically stable. Say that you found a way to replace $t \rightarrow t_n$ that is stable and that you could have used other ways which are also correct to within $\mathcal{O}(\Delta t)$.
- It allows for overhangs
- It is the first study that describes a bulk fluid coupled to a Helfrich membrane with ALE

- It allows for turbulent behavior for both the bulk fluid and the membrane tangential flow

Perspectives:

1. Study nucleoid compaction in E. Coli with ALE
2. arc length gauge in 2d

I. FLUID AND RIGID BODY

In this Section, we will discuss the interaction between a **bulk fluid** (**F**) and the simplest structure—a **rigid body** (**R**) which is only allowed to turn about one point.

In all the systems that we will consider, we will introduce the **reference** (**r**) and **current** (**c**) configuration [2–4], see Fig. 1. All quantities relative to the **r** and **c** configuration will be denoted by the superscript **r** and **c**, respectively. In the **r** configuration, the region occupied by the bulk fluid is described by Cartesian coordinates $\mathbf{x}_r$. The axis of the ellipse, e.g, the rigid body, lies parallel to the x_c^1 axis. In the **c** configuration, the region occupied by the bulk fluid is described by Cartesian coordinates $\mathbf{x}_c$. The axis of the ellipse, e.g, the rigid body, forms an angle θ (red arc) with respect to the x_c^1 axis.

The **r** configuration, is related to the **c** one as follows [2], see Fig. 1. At time t , the point $\mathbf{x}_c$ corresponds to a point $\mathbf{x}_r$ in the reference configuration through the deformation field [5]

$$\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r) \equiv \mathbf{x}_c - \mathbf{x}_r. \quad (1)$$

and the deformation-gradient tensor

$$F_{\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}) \equiv \delta_{\alpha\beta} + \frac{\partial u^\alpha}{\partial x_r^\beta}, \quad (2)$$

read [6]

where we set

$$\partial_\alpha^r \equiv \frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\alpha}, \quad (3)$$

$$\partial_\alpha^c \equiv \frac{\partial}{\partial x_c^\alpha}. \quad (4)$$

Here, we will denote the mapping between $\mathbf{x}_c$ and $\mathbf{x}_r$ in Eq. (1) with the fields

$$\mathbf{x}_c = \varphi^t(\mathbf{x}_r), \quad (5)$$

$$\mathbf{x}_r = \psi^t(\mathbf{x}_c). \quad (6)$$

We denote the $\mathbf{F}$ velocity and surface tension by $v_{F_c}(\mathbf{x}_c)$ and $\sigma_{F_c}(\mathbf{x}_c)$, respectively, where the superscript $\mathbf{c}$ specifies that these fields depend on the coordinate $\mathbf{x}_c$ in the $\mathbf{c}$ configuration.

The solution of the interaction dynamics between $\mathbf{F}$ and $\mathbf{R}$ is involved because of the presence of the moving boundary $\partial\Omega_\Omega^c$, cf. Fig. 1. Following the **arbitrary Lagrangian-Eulerian (ALE)** procedure, we will bridge between the Lagrangian and the Eulerian description used to describe, respectively, $\mathbf{R}$ and $\mathbf{F}$ [2]. To achieve this, in what follows we will write the equations of motion for $\mathbf{R}$ and $\mathbf{F}$, which are naturally formulated the $\mathbf{c}$ configuration first, and then rewrite them in the $\mathbf{r}$ configuration.

A. Rigid body motion

In this Section, we will work out the equations of motion for $\mathbf{R}$.

1. Equation of motion in the **current**-configuration coordinates

The dynamics of $\mathbf{R}$ is given by the equations of motion for a rigid body which, in $\mathbf{c}$ coordinates,

Equation (7) relates the angular acceleration of $\mathbf{R}$ to the torque of external forces. In what follows, greek indices $\alpha, \beta, \dots$ will be used to denote vectors and tensors in two-dimensional Euclidean space—their

position as upper or lower indices is thus immaterial [3, 7]. The moment of inertia of $\mathbf{R}$ is denoted by I . The **right-hand side (RHS)** of Eq. (7) contains the line integral along the boundary of $\mathbf{R}$, of the torque of the local force exerted by $\mathbf{F}$ on $\mathbf{R}$ with respect to the left focal point $\mathbf{f}$ of $\mathbf{R}$ [5]. This force is expressed in terms of the $\mathbf{F}$ stress tensor [5]

$$\varsigma_{\alpha\beta}^c \equiv \sigma_{F_c} \delta_{\alpha\beta} + \eta_F \left(\frac{\partial v_{F_c}^\alpha}{\partial x_c^\beta} + \frac{\partial v_{F_c}^\beta}{\partial x_c^\alpha} \right), \quad (9)$$

where $\epsilon_{\alpha\beta\gamma}$ is the three-dimensional Levi-Civita symbol, and η_F the two-dimensional viscosity of $\mathbf{F}$. Finally, dl_c is the line element of $\partial\Omega_\Omega^c$ in the $\mathbf{c}$ configuration, and $\hat{\mathbf{n}}^c$ the unit boundary normal to $\partial\Omega_\Omega^c$ pointing outside Ω^c .

2. Equation of motion in the **reference**-configuration coordinates

$$I \frac{d\omega}{dt} = \int_{\partial\Omega_\Omega^r} ds \epsilon_{\alpha\beta} [\varphi^{\alpha,t}(\xi(s)) - f^\alpha] \varsigma^r_{\beta\gamma}(\xi(s)) \epsilon_{\gamma\lambda} F_{\lambda\mu}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\xi(s))) \frac{d\xi^\mu(s)}{ds} \quad (10)$$

In Eq. (10), the integral in the **RHS** is over the

curvilinear boundary $\partial\Omega_\Omega^r$, which is parametrized

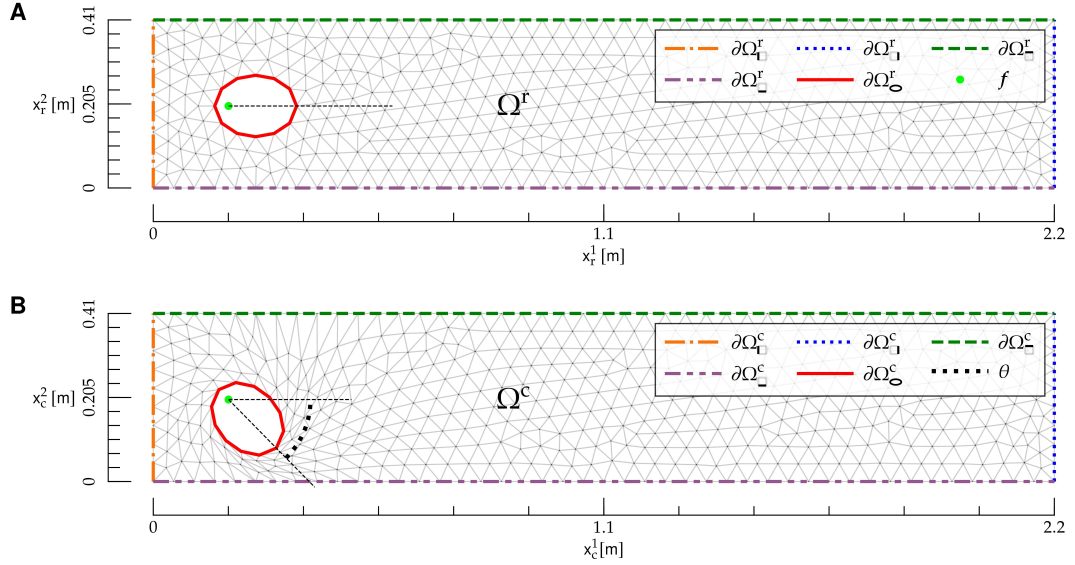


FIG. 1: Reference and current configuration for the interaction between a bulk fluid and a rigid body. **A)** Reference configuration. The region Ω^r is given by the rectangle $0 \leq x_r^1 \leq L$, $0 \leq x_r^2 \leq h$ with the elliptical hole, and is delimited by the mesh (gray lines). Boundaries in the reference configuration are denoted by $\partial\Omega_{\square}^r$, $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$, $\partial\Omega_{\square}^f$ (colored dashed lines). The ellipse focal point f (light green dot) is also shown. **B)** Current configuration. The region Ω^c is delimited by the mesh (gray lines). Boundaries in the current configuration are denoted by $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$, $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$, $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$, $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$ and $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$ (colored dashed lines), and the rotational angle θ of the rigid body is shown as an arc (black dotted line). The Cartesian coordinates $\mathbf{x}_c$ are also shown.

as $\mathbf{x}_r = \boldsymbol{\xi}(s)$, where s is the curvilinear coordinate. Also, $\epsilon_{\alpha\beta}$ is the two-dimensional Levi-Civita symbol [7], and ς^r denotes the stress tensor in the **r** configuration:

$$\begin{aligned} \varsigma_{\alpha\beta}^{rt}(\mathbf{x}_r) &\equiv \varsigma_{\alpha\beta}^c(\boldsymbol{\varphi}^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \\ &= \sigma_{Fr}(\mathbf{x}_r, t)\delta_{\alpha\beta} + \eta_F \left[G_{\gamma\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{Fc}^\alpha}{\partial x_r^\gamma} + \right. \\ &\quad \left. G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{Fc}^\beta}{\partial x_r^\gamma} \right], \end{aligned} \quad (11)$$

where

$$G_{\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}) \equiv [F(\mathbf{u})]_{\alpha\beta}^{-1}. \quad (12)$$

B. Fluid motion

In this Section, we will work out the equations of motion for **F**.

1. Equations of motion in the current-configuration coordinates

The equations of motion, expressed in terms of the **c** fields v_{Fc} and σ_{Fc} , are

$$\rho_F \left(\partial_t v_{Fc}^\alpha + v_{Fc}^\beta \frac{\partial v_{Fc}^\alpha}{\partial x_c^\beta} \right) = \frac{\partial \sigma_{Fc}^\alpha}{\partial x_c^\alpha} + \eta_F \frac{\partial}{\partial x_c^\beta} \frac{\partial v_{Fc}^\alpha}{\partial x_c^\beta}, \quad (13)$$

$$\frac{\partial v_{Fc}^\alpha}{\partial x_c^\alpha} = 0, \quad (14)$$

and they hold for $\mathbf{x}_c \in \Omega^c$. Equations (13) and (14) are the **Navier-Stokes (NS)** and continuity equation, respectively, in a flat, two-dimensional geometry [5]—an example of the **NS** equations on curved geometry will be presented in X. There, ρ_F is the two-dimensional **F** density.

The **boundary conditions (BCs)** for Eqs. (7), (8), (13) and (14) are

$$v_{Fc}^1(\mathbf{x}_c) = v_* \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c, \quad (15)$$

$$v_{Fc}^2(\mathbf{x}_c) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c, \quad (16)$$

$$\mathbf{v}_{Fc}(\mathbf{x}_c) = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c, \quad (17)$$

$$v_{Fc}^\alpha(\mathbf{x}_c) = \frac{d[R(\theta)]_{\alpha\beta}}{dt} [\psi^{t\beta}(\mathbf{x}_c) - f^\beta] \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c, \quad (18)$$

$$\eta_F \frac{\partial v_{Fc}^\alpha}{\partial x_c^1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c, \quad (19)$$

$$\sigma_{Fc}(\mathbf{x}_c) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c. \quad (20)$$

Equations (15) and (16) ensure that $\mathbf{F}$ is injected on the boundary $\partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^c$ in a direction parallel to the $\mathbf{x}_c^1$ axis, and Eq. (17) is a no-slip BC [5] along the channel walls $\partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^c$, see Fig. 1. Equation (18) ensures that, at the boundary $\partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^c$, the $\mathbf{F}$ velocity matches the rotational velocity of $\mathbf{R}$. Given that $\mathbf{R}$ can only rotate about its left focal point $\mathbf{f}$, the $\mathbf{R}$ rotational velocity of a point $\mathbf{x}_c \in \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^c$ is given by

$$\frac{d[R(\theta)]_{\alpha\beta}}{dt}[\psi^{t\beta}(\mathbf{x}_c) - c_\beta], \quad (21)$$

where $\mathbf{R}$ is the rotation matrix corresponding to a counterclockwise rotation:

$$\mathbf{R}(\theta) \equiv \begin{pmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{pmatrix}. \quad (22)$$

Finally, Eqs. (19) and (20) ensure, respectively, that on $\partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^c$ there is zero traction and tension; this

corresponds to the hypothesis that there is free flow at $\partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^c$ [5, 8].

2. Equations of motion in the *reference*-configuration coordinates

For each field $\mathbf{v}_{F_c}(\mathbf{x}_c), \sigma_{F_c}(\mathbf{x}_c)$ which depends on the coordinate $\mathbf{x}_c$ in the *c* configuration, we introduce its counterpart in the *r* configuration:

$$\mathbf{v}_{F_c}(\mathbf{x}_r, t) \equiv \mathbf{v}_{F_r}(\boldsymbol{\varphi}^t(\mathbf{x}_r), t), \quad (23)$$

$$\sigma_{F_c}(\mathbf{x}_r, t) \equiv \sigma_{F_r}(\boldsymbol{\varphi}^t(\mathbf{x}_r), t). \quad (24)$$

We will now rewrite the equations of motion and the BCs in terms of $\mathbf{v}_{F_c}, \sigma_{F_c}$, and the *r* coordinate $\mathbf{x}_r$. The equations of motion (13) and (14) yield

$$\rho_F \left\{ \frac{\partial v_{F_r}^\alpha(\mathbf{x}_r, t)}{\partial t} + \left[v_{F_r}^\gamma(\mathbf{x}_r, t) - \frac{d\varphi^{\gamma t}(\mathbf{x}_r)}{dt} \right] G_{\beta\gamma}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{F_r}^\alpha(\mathbf{x}_r, t)}{\partial x_r^\beta} \right\} = \quad (25)$$

$$G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial \sigma_{F_r}^\beta(\mathbf{x}_r, t)}{\partial x_r^\beta} + \eta_F G_{\delta\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\delta} \left[G_{\gamma\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{F_r}^\gamma(\mathbf{x}_r, t)}{\partial x_r^\gamma} \right],$$

$$G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{F_r}^\alpha(\mathbf{x}_r, t)}{\partial x_r^\beta} = 0, \quad (26)$$

which hold in Ω^r .

The BCs (15) to (20) are rewritten as

$$v_{F_r}^1(\mathbf{x}_r) = v_* \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r, \quad (27)$$

$$v_{F_r}^2(\mathbf{x}_r) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r, \quad (28)$$

$$v_{F_r}(\mathbf{x}_r) = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r, \quad (29)$$

$$v_{F_r}^\alpha(\mathbf{x}_r) = \frac{d[R(\theta)]_{\alpha\beta}}{dt}[\mathbf{x}_r^\beta - \mathbf{f}^\beta] \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r, \quad (30)$$

$$\eta_F G_{\beta 1}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{F_r}^\alpha}{\partial x_r^\beta} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r, \quad (31)$$

$$\sigma_{F_r}(\mathbf{x}_r) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r. \quad (32)$$

C. Motion of bulk fluid domain

The equations of motion (10) and (25) to (32) involve the displacement field $\mathbf{u}_D$, which describes how the region—or domain—which contains $\mathbf{F}$, is deformed in time, cf. Fig. 1. We will denote this region as the *D*. We observe that this field has, so far, been left arbitrary, and we have the freedom to choose it.

Here, $\mathbf{u}_D$ will be determined with an analogy with the theory of elasticity [2]. We imagine that, as $\mathbf{R}$ rotates about its focal point, each point $\mathbf{x}_r \in \Omega^r$ moves into a point $\mathbf{x}_c \in \Omega^c$, and that the domain Ω^r is deformed, e.g., locally stretched and compressed, into Ω^c , like an elastic medium.

We will thus determine $\mathbf{u}_D$ as the solution of a *boundary-value problem (BVP)* given by the following elastic model [2, 9]

$$\frac{\partial S_{D\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D)}{\partial x_r^\beta} = 0 \text{ in } \Omega^r, \quad (33)$$

where the elastic stress tensor S_D is given by

$$S_{D\alpha\beta} \equiv F_{\alpha\gamma} T_{\gamma\beta}, \quad (34)$$

and

$$T_{\alpha\beta} \equiv K(\mathbf{u}_D) E_{\gamma\gamma} \delta_{\alpha\beta} + 2\mu(\mathbf{u}_D) \left[E_{\alpha\beta} - \frac{1}{2} \delta_{\alpha\beta} E_{\gamma\gamma} \right], \quad (35)$$

$$E_{\alpha\beta} \equiv \frac{1}{2} (F_{\gamma\alpha} F_{\gamma\beta} - \delta_{\alpha\beta}), \quad (36)$$

$$K(\mathbf{u}) \equiv \frac{1}{[\det(F(\mathbf{u}))]^\zeta}, \quad (37)$$

$$\mu(\mathbf{u}) \equiv \frac{1}{[\det(F(\mathbf{u}))]^\zeta}. \quad (38)$$

In Eqs. (37) and (38), we included an additional dependence of bulk modulus K and the modulus of compression μ on the deformation-gradient tensor (2). In the absence of this dependence, the elastic model above would be unstable under local compression. In fact, the model's Lagrangian would not penalize configurations with small $\det F$. The inclusion of the dependence (37) and (38) on $\det F$ allows for penalizing these configurations—the larger the exponent $\zeta > 0$, the stronger the penalty. As a result, this dependence makes the model stable under mesh compression, such as the one shown below **R** in Fig. 1B.

The BCs for the partial differential equation (PDE) (33) are

$$\mathbf{u}_D = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^r, \quad (39)$$

$$\mathbf{u}_D = \mathbf{f} - \mathbf{x}_r + \mathbf{R}(\theta) \cdot (\mathbf{x}_r - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^r. \quad (40)$$

Equation (39) enforces the fact that the mesh is not deformed at the boundary $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^r$. Finally, Eq. (40) ensures that the mesh deformation at $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^r$ matches the deformation induced by the rotation of **R**.

Equations (33), (39) and (40) constitute the BVP which determines $\mathbf{u}_D$. Along the lines of BVPs in the theory of elasticity, such BVP is already, naturally formulated in the **r** configuration [3].

From the BVP above, we obtain a BVP for $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D$, which will be needed in the following to describe the **D** motion. By deriving both sides of Eqs. (33), (39) and (40), we obtain, respectively,

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\beta} \frac{dS_{D\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D)}{dt} = 0 \text{ in } \Omega^r, \quad (41)$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^r, \quad (42)$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D = \omega \frac{d\mathbf{R}}{d\theta} \cdot (\mathbf{x}_r - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^r, \quad (43)$$

where in Eqs. (42) and (43) we used the fact that $\mathbf{x}_r$ is independent of time, and in Eq. (43) we substituted Eq. (8). The left-hand side (LHS) of Eq. (41) depends on the second partial derivatives of $\mathbf{u}_D$ and $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D$ —see Eqs. (34) to (38). As a result, given θ , ω , and $\mathbf{u}_D$ from Eqs. (33), (39) and (40), the BVP (41) to (43) yields $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D$.

Overall Eqs. (8), (10), (25) to (33) and (39) to (43) constitute a BVP for $\theta, \omega, \mathbf{v}_{F_r}, \sigma_{F_r}, \mathbf{u}_D$ and $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D$ which, combined with the temporal BCs

$$\theta(t=0) = \theta_0 \quad (44)$$

$$\omega(t=0) = \omega_0 \quad (45)$$

$$\mathbf{v}_{F_r}(\mathbf{x}_r, t=0) = \mathbf{v}_{F_r0}(\mathbf{x}_r), \quad (46)$$

$$\sigma_{F_r}(\mathbf{x}_r, t=0) = \sigma_{F_r0}(\mathbf{x}_r), \quad (47)$$

determine the dynamics of the system.

D. Temporal discretization

To numerically solve for the dynamics in a time span $0 \leq t \leq T$, we discretize time by setting $\Delta t \equiv T/N$, $t_n \equiv n \Delta t$, with $n = 0, 1, \dots, N$.

We combine the Crank Nicolson (CN) discretization method for NS equations [8, 10] with the ALE formulation, by discretizing the dynamical equations for **R**, **F** and **D**—see below.

1. Rigid body

Proceeding along the CN scheme [10], we define fields at staggered, integer and semi-integer time steps scheme [8]. We set

$$\sigma_{F_r}^n(\mathbf{x}_r) \equiv \sigma_{F_c}(\mathbf{x}_r, t_n) \quad (48)$$

$$\sigma_{F_r}^{n-1/2}(\mathbf{x}_r) \equiv \sigma_{F_c} \left(\mathbf{x}_r, \frac{t_n + t_{n-1}}{2} \right), \quad (49)$$

and similarly for other quantities.

We discretize Eqs. (8) and (10) and, neglecting $\mathcal{O}(\Delta t)$, we obtain

$$\frac{\theta^n - \theta^{n-1}}{\Delta t} = \omega^n, \quad (50)$$

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\omega^n - \omega^{n-1}}{\Delta t} = & I \int_{\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{r}}} ds \epsilon_{\alpha\beta} [\xi^\alpha(s) + u^{n-1,\alpha}(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s)) - f^\alpha] \zeta_{\beta\gamma}^{r^{n-1}}(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s); \mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{F}_r}^{n-1}, \sigma_{\mathbf{F}_r}^{n-3/2}) \times \\ & \epsilon_{\gamma\lambda} F_{\lambda\mu}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s))) \frac{d\xi^\mu(s)}{ds}, \end{aligned} \quad (51)$$

where in Eq. (51) we used Eqs. (1) and (5) and we explicitly indicated the dependence of the stress tensor (11) on $\mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{F}_c}$ and $\sigma_{\mathbf{F}_c}$.

2. Bulk fluid

To discretize in time the **F** problem, we will apply the **CN** splitting scheme [8, 10] to the **NS** equations

(25) and (26) in the **r** configurations. This splitting scheme is derived from the **incremental pressure correction scheme** [11], in which the solution of the **NS** equations is split into three intermediate steps. In what follows, we will synonymously use the terms ‘pressure’ and ‘surface tension’ for conciseness [12].

The discrete form of the **PDEs** Eqs. (25) and (26) is

$$\rho_F \left[\frac{v_{\mathbf{F}_r}^{n,\alpha} - v_{\mathbf{F}_r}^{n-1,\alpha}}{\Delta t} + \frac{3}{2} (v_{\mathbf{F}_r}^{n-1,\gamma} - \dot{u}^{n-1,\gamma}) G_{\beta\gamma}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial v_{\mathbf{F}_r}^{n-1,\alpha}}{\partial x_r^\beta} - \frac{1}{2} (v_{\mathbf{F}_r}^{n-2,\gamma} - \dot{u}^{n-2,\gamma}) \times \right. \quad (52)$$

$$\begin{aligned} & \left. G_{\beta\gamma}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-2}) \frac{\partial v_{\mathbf{F}_r}^{n-2,\alpha}}{\partial x_r^\beta} \right] = \\ & G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \sigma_{\mathbf{F}_r}^{n-1/2}}{\partial x_r^\beta} + \eta_F G_{\delta\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\delta} \left[G_{\gamma\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\gamma} \left(\frac{v_{\mathbf{F}_r}^{n,\alpha} + v_{\mathbf{F}_r}^{n-1,\alpha}}{2} \right) \right], \\ & G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial v_{\mathbf{F}_r}^{n,\alpha}}{\partial x_r^\beta} = 0, \quad (53) \end{aligned}$$

where we omitted the dependence on $\mathbf{x}_r$ for clarity. Also, in the **LHS** of Eq. (52) we rewrote the convective term according to the Adams-Bashforth discretization scheme [8, 13], and we used Eqs. (1)

and (5) to rewrite the time derivative of $\boldsymbol{\varphi}$ in terms of $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D$.

The discrete form of the **BCs** (27) to (32) reads

$$v_{\text{Fr}}^{n,1} = v_* \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^{\text{r}}, \quad (54)$$

$$v_{\text{Fr}}^{n,2} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^{\text{r}}, \quad (55)$$

$$\mathbf{v}_{\text{Fr}}^n = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^{\text{r}}, \quad (56)$$

$$\mathbf{v}_{\text{Fr}} = \omega^n \frac{d\mathbf{R}}{d\theta} \Big|_{\theta=\theta_n} \cdot (\mathbf{x}_{\text{r}} - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^{\text{r}}, \quad (57)$$

$$\eta_{\text{F}} G_{\beta 1}(\mathbf{u}_{\text{D}}^{n-1}) \frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}_{\text{r}}^{\beta}} \left(\frac{v_{\text{Fr}}^{n,\alpha} + v_{\text{Fr}}^{n-1,\alpha}}{2} \right) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^{\text{r}}, \quad (58)$$

$$\sigma_{\text{Fr}}^{n-1/2} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^{\text{r}}. \quad (59)$$

We will now split the **BVP** into three steps [8, 14]:

the velocity $\bar{\mathbf{v}}$, which approximates the true velocity $\mathbf{v}_{\text{Fr}}$, and which satisfies the **BVP**

1. **Approximated velocity.** We introduce

$$\rho_{\text{F}} \left\{ \frac{\bar{v}^{\alpha} - v_{\text{Fr}}^{n-1,\alpha}}{\Delta t} + \left[\frac{3}{2} (v_{\text{Fr}}^{n-1,\gamma} - \dot{u}^{n-1,\gamma}) G_{\beta\gamma}(\mathbf{u}_{\text{D}}^{n-1}) - \frac{1}{2} (v_{\text{Fr}}^{n-2,\gamma} - \dot{u}^{n-2,\gamma}) G_{\beta\gamma}(\mathbf{u}_{\text{D}}^{n-2}) \right] \frac{\partial V^{\alpha}}{\partial \mathbf{x}_{\text{r}}^{\beta}} \right\} = \quad (60)$$

$$G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_{\text{D}}^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \sigma_{\text{Fr}}^*}{\partial \mathbf{x}_{\text{r}}^{\beta}} + \eta_{\text{F}} G_{\delta\beta}(\mathbf{u}_{\text{D}}^{n-1}) \frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}_{\text{r}}^{\delta}} \left(G_{\gamma\beta}(\mathbf{u}_{\text{D}}^{n-1}) \frac{\partial V^{\alpha}}{\partial \mathbf{x}_{\text{r}}^{\gamma}} \right),$$

$$\bar{v}^1 = v_* \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^{\text{r}}, \quad (61)$$

$$\bar{v}^2 = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^{\text{r}}, \quad (62)$$

$$\bar{\mathbf{v}} = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^{\text{r}}, \quad (63)$$

$$\bar{\mathbf{v}} = \omega^n \frac{d\mathbf{R}}{d\theta} \Big|_{\theta=\theta_n} \cdot (\mathbf{x}_{\text{r}} - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^{\text{r}}, \quad (64)$$

$$\eta_{\text{F}} G_{\beta 1}(\mathbf{u}_{\text{D}}^{n-1}) \frac{\partial V^{\alpha}}{\partial \mathbf{x}_{\text{r}}^{\beta}} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^{\text{r}}. \quad (65)$$

where

$$\mathbf{V} \equiv \frac{\bar{\mathbf{v}} + \mathbf{v}_{\text{Fr}}^{n-1}}{2}, \quad (66)$$

$$\sigma_{\text{Fr}}^* \equiv \sigma_{\text{Fr}}^{n-3/2}. \quad (67)$$

2. **Pressure correction.**

Subtracting Eqs. (52) and (60) and neglecting $\mathcal{O}(\Delta t)$, we obtain

$$\rho_{\text{F}} \frac{\bar{v}^{\alpha} - v_{\text{Fr}}^{n,\alpha}}{\Delta t} = G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_{\text{D}}^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial \mathbf{x}_{\text{r}}^{\beta}} \text{ in } \Omega^{\text{r}}, \quad (68)$$

where

$$\phi \equiv \sigma_{\text{Fc}}^* - \sigma_{\text{Fc}}^{n-1/2} \quad (69)$$

is the surface-tension increment. By applying $G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_{\text{D}}^{n-1}) \partial / \partial \mathbf{x}_{\text{r}}^{\gamma}$ to both sides of Eq. (68) and using Eq. (53), we obtain a second-order **PDE** for ϕ :

$$\frac{\rho_{\text{F}}}{\Delta t} G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_{\text{D}}^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \bar{v}^{\alpha}}{\partial \mathbf{x}_{\text{r}}^{\gamma}} = \quad (70)$$

$$G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_{\text{D}}^{n-1}) \frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}_{\text{r}}^{\gamma}} \left(G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_{\text{D}}^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial \mathbf{x}_{\text{r}}^{\beta}} \right).$$

We will now work out the **BCs** for Eq. (70). Equations (59), (67) and (69) imply the **BC**

$$\phi = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r. \quad (71)$$

Multiplying Eq. (68) by $G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1})\hat{n}^r\gamma$, where $\hat{n}^r$ is the unit boundary normal in the **r** configuration, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\rho_F}{\Delta t} G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1})\hat{n}^r\gamma(\bar{v}^\alpha - v_{F_r}^{n,\alpha}) = \\ \hat{n}^r\gamma G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1})G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1})\frac{\partial\phi}{\partial x_r^\beta}. \end{aligned} \quad (72)$$

Combining Eq. (72) with Eqs. (54) to (57) and (61) to (64), we obtain the second **BC**

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{n}^r\gamma G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1})G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1})\frac{\partial\phi}{\partial x_r^\beta} = \\ 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r \cup \partial\Omega_{\Sigma}^r \cup \partial\Omega_{\Omega}^r. \end{aligned} \quad (73)$$

The **BVP** (70), (71) and (73) determines ϕ and, through the definition (69), the surface tension $\sigma_c^{n-1/2}$.

3. **Velocity correction.** The velocity $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^n$ is determined from the approximate velocity $\bar{\mathbf{v}}$ from Eq. (68).

3. Bulk fluid domain

The discrete version of the **BVP** for $\mathbf{u}_D$, Eqs. (33), (39) and (40), reads

$$\frac{\partial S_{D\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^n)}{\partial x_r^\beta} = 0 \text{ in } \Omega^r, \quad (74)$$

$$\mathbf{u}_D^n = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r, \quad (75)$$

$$\mathbf{u}_D^n = \mathbf{f} - \mathbf{x}_r + \mathbf{R}(\theta^n) \cdot (\mathbf{x}_r - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Sigma}^r, \quad (76)$$

and that of the **BVP** for $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D$, Eqs. (41) to (43), is

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\beta} \frac{dS_{D\alpha\beta}(\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n)}{dt} = 0 \text{ in } \Omega^r, \quad (77)$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r, \quad (78)$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n = \omega \frac{d\mathbf{R}}{d\theta} \cdot (\mathbf{x}_r - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Sigma}^r, \quad (79)$$

We can now iterate in time for the ensemble of fields as follows. At each step n , given θ^{n-1} , ω^{n-1} , $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^{n-1}$, $\sigma_{F_r}^{n-3/2}$, $\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}$ and $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^{n-1}$ from the preceding step, we

1. **Update R.** Solve the algebraic equations Eqs. (50) and (51) for θ^n and ω^n .
2. **Update D.** Solve the **BVPs** (74) to (79) for $\mathbf{u}_D^n$ and $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n$.
3. **Update F.** Solve the **BVPs** (60) to (65) and (71) to (73) for $\bar{\mathbf{v}}$ and $\sigma_{F_r}^{n-1/2}$, and obtain $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^n$ from Eq. (68).

The fields $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^{n-1}$, $\sigma_{F_r}^{n-3/2}$ in the **c** configuration are then obtained from the respective fields in the **r** configuration through Eqs. (23) and (24).

An example of such dynamics is shown in Fig. 2. The channel has dimensions $L = 2.2$ m, $h = 0.41$ m, cf. Fig. 1, $\rho_F = 1$ Kg/m², $\eta_F = 10^{-3}$ Pa m sec, and the inflow velocity profile is a Poiseuille flow $v_*(\mathbf{x}_c) = 6v_0x_c^2(x_c^2 - h)/h^2$, with $v_0 = 1$ m/sec. These parameters have been taken from the FEAT2D DFG 2D-3 benchmark for a flow around a cylinder [15]. The **D** mesh stiffness exponent has been chosen to be $\zeta = 3$ [2]. Finally, **R** is an ellipse with semi-axes $a = 0.1$ m, $b = 0.075$ m, center located at $\mathbf{x}_r = (0.25 \text{ m}, 0.2 \text{ m})$, and moment of inertia $I = 10^{-1}$ Kg m². These parameters correspond approximately to a light gas interacting with a solid body made of light wood.

As shown in Fig. 3, the dynamics of Fig. 2 involves two physical time scales: A short one, τ_S , related to fast angular oscillations of **B**, and a long one, τ_L , given by the damping of such oscillations.

First, the scale τ_S can be estimated by considering the dynamical equation (7) for **B**, and approximating its **LHS** as I/τ_S^2 and its **RHS** as $(\eta_F v_0/a)2\pi a$. Here, $\eta_F v_0/a$ is the viscous component of the force per unit length exerted by **F** on **B**, cf. Eq. (9), $2\pi a$ estimates the total length of the boundary of **B**, and a approximates the lever arm of the force above. Putting everything together, we obtain

$$\tau_S \sim \sqrt{\frac{I}{2\pi a \eta_F v_0}}. \quad (80)$$

For the parameters of Fig. 2, Eq. (80) yields $\tau_S \sim 13$ sec, which is in agreement with the period of the oscillations in Fig. 3.

Second, τ_L can be estimated by building a combination of the material parameters ρ_F , η_F and I of the model. The only parameter combination that can yield a quantity with the dimensions of a time is

$$\tau_L \sim \frac{\sqrt{\rho_F I}}{\eta_F}. \quad (81)$$

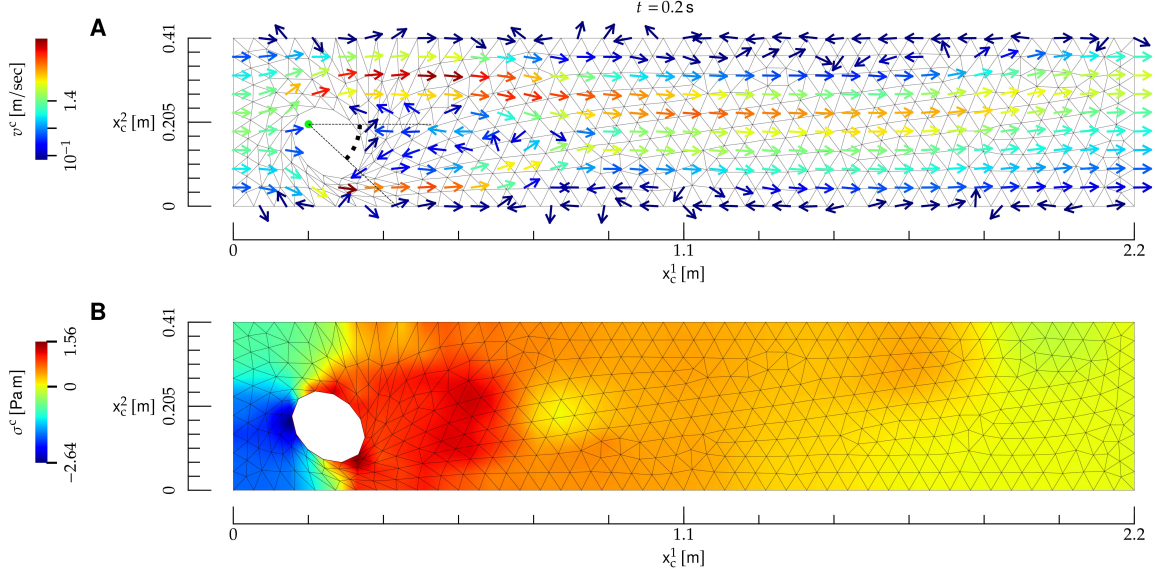


FIG. 2: Interaction between a **bulk fluid** and a rigid **body**, whose material properties roughly correspond to a light gas and a body made of light wood, respectively. **A)** Temporal snapshot of the mesh (black lines) and velocity field (arrows) at the **current** time t , shown on top. The direction of the velocity field is indicated by the arrows, and its norm by their color; the direction of arrows with velocity close to zero is not defined. The **body** (ellipse) is allowed to pivot about its left focal point (red dot), and the related angle with respect to the x_c^1 direction is denoted by a red arc. **B)** Color map of the surface tension at the **current** instant of time t .

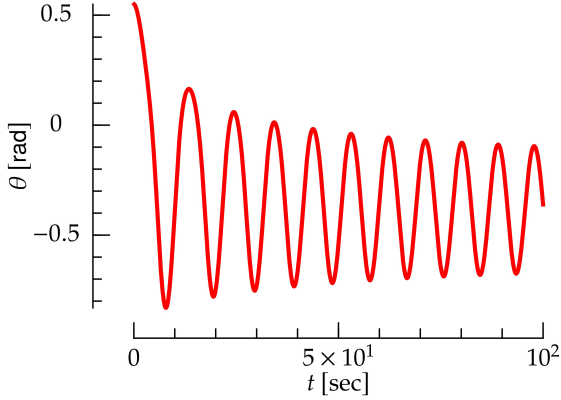


FIG. 3: Angle of the **body** as a function of time for the interaction between a **bulk fluid** and a rigid **body** shown in Fig. 2.

II. FLUID AND ELASTIC BODY

In this Section, we will build on the analysis of Section I and put **F** into interaction with a more complex physical object: an **elastic body** (**E**). Only the main results will be presented here; their derivation follows the lines of Section I.

The **r** and **c** configurations are shown in Fig. 4. Here, the **E** boundary $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}$ may deform, but the inner **E** boundary $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}$ is pinned to the x_c^1, x_c^2 plane.

The equations of motion are the following.

First, the dynamics of **F** is governed by the **NS** and mass-conservation equations (13) and (14), respectively. Their **BCs** are Eqs. (15) to (17), (19) and (20), which stay unchanged. On the other hand, **BC** (18), which ensures that the **F** velocity matches the **B** velocity at the interface between **F** and **B**, now reads

$$\mathbf{v}_{F_c}(\mathbf{x}_c) = \left. \frac{d\mathbf{u}_E(\mathbf{x}_r)}{dt} \right|_{\mathbf{x}_r=\psi^t(\mathbf{x}_c)} \quad \text{on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^c \quad (82)$$

Second, the motion of **E** is governed by Newton's equations of motion for an elastic body [3]

$$\rho_E \frac{d^2 u_E^\alpha(\mathbf{x}_r)}{dt^2} = \frac{\partial S_{E\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_E)}{\partial x_r^\beta}, \quad (83)$$

For the parameters of Fig. 2, Eq. (81) yields $\tau_L \sim 316$ sec, which is roughly the timescale at which the width of the oscillations in Fig. 3 is dampened out.

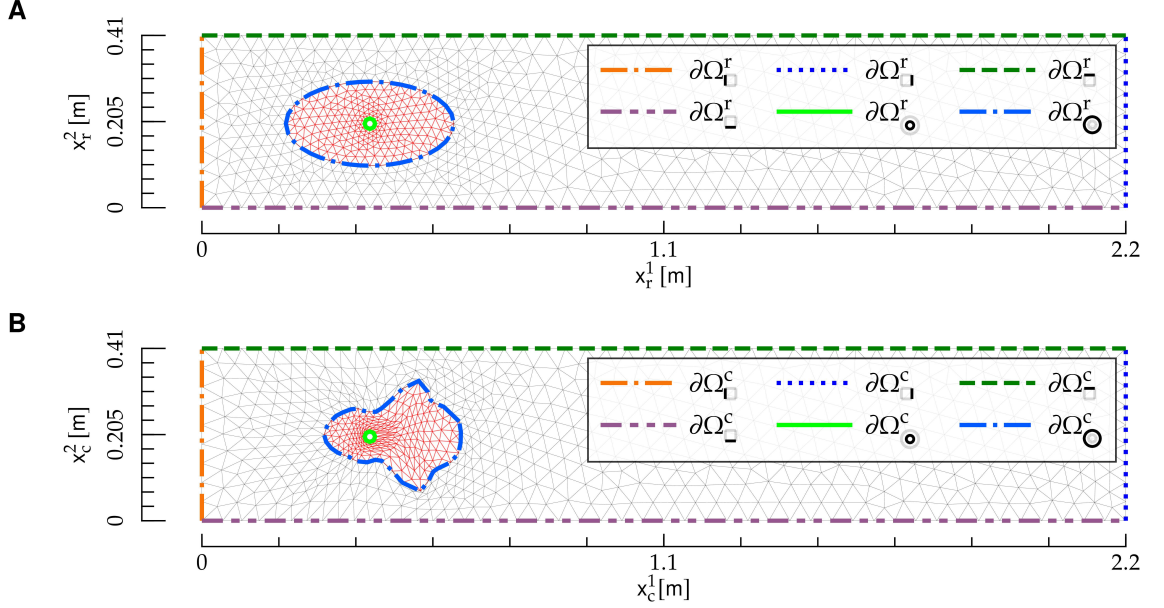


FIG. 4: Reference and current configuration for the interaction between a **bulk fluid** and an **elastic body**. The figures follows the same notation as Fig. 1. In panels **A** and **B**, the domains Ω^r and Ω^c are the regions covered by the mesh, respectively.

where ρ_E is the density of **E** which is assumed to be independent of space. Also, $\mathbf{u}_E$ is the deformation field of **E**, which is defined along the lines of Eq. (1). The **E** stress tensor is derived from a compressible neo-Hookean model [16], and it reads

$$S_{E\alpha\beta} \equiv \frac{\mu}{\det(F)} \left(-\frac{1}{2} C_{\gamma\gamma} G_{\alpha\beta} + F_{\beta\alpha} \right) + K[(\det(F))^2 - 1] G_{\alpha\beta}, \quad (84)$$

where

$$C_{\alpha\beta} \equiv \delta_{\alpha\beta} + 2E_{\alpha\beta}. \quad (85)$$

We have chosen this model because it is stable under compression, i.e., its potential energy diverges as $\det(F) \rightarrow 0$ [16]. As opposed to linear models [3] and to the elastic model of Section IC, this model proves to yield a stable dynamics for **E** as it is compressed by **F**, see below and Fig. 5. The BCs for Eq. (83) are

$$\mathbf{u}_E(\mathbf{x}_r) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\odot}^r, \quad (86)$$

$$\epsilon_{\beta\gamma} S_{E\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_E^t)|_{\mathbf{x}_r=\boldsymbol{\xi}(s)} \frac{d\xi^\gamma}{ds} = \quad (87)$$

$$\varsigma_{\alpha\beta}^c(\boldsymbol{\varphi}^t(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s))) \epsilon_{\beta\gamma} \frac{d\varphi^{t,\gamma}(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s))}{ds} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\odot}^r.$$

Finally, the equations of motion for **D** are (33)

and (41), with BCs (39) and (42) and

$$\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r) = \mathbf{u}_E^t(\mathbf{x}_r) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\odot}^r, \quad (88)$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r) = \dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^t(\mathbf{x}_r) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\odot}^r. \quad (89)$$

Equation (88) and Eq. (89) ensure that the displacement and velocity of **E** and **D** are conformal at the **E-D** interface, and they replace Eqs. (40) and (43), respectively.

The system dynamics is obtained as follows: given $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^{n-1}$, $\sigma_{F_r}^{n-3/2}$, $\mathbf{u}_E^{n-1}$, $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^{n-1}$, $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^{n-1}$ and $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^{n-1}$ from the preceding step, we

- **Update E.** Solve for $\mathbf{u}_E^n$ and $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^n$ the discrete version of Eq. (83)

$$\rho_E \frac{\dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^{n,\alpha} - \dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^{n-1,\alpha}}{\Delta t} = \frac{\partial S_{E\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_E^n)}{\partial x_r^\beta}, \quad (90)$$

$$\frac{\mathbf{u}_E^n - \mathbf{u}_E^{n-1}}{\Delta t} = \dot{\mathbf{u}}_E, \quad (91)$$

with BCs obtained from Eqs. (86) and (87):

$$\mathbf{u}_E^n = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r, \quad (92)$$

$$\epsilon_{\beta\gamma} S_{E\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_E^n)|_{\mathbf{x}_r=\boldsymbol{\xi}(s)} \frac{d\xi^\gamma}{ds} = \varsigma_{\alpha\beta}^r(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s); \mathbf{v}_{Fr}^{n-1}, \sigma_{Fr}^{n-3/2}, \mathbf{u}^n) \epsilon_{\beta\gamma} F_{\gamma\delta}(\mathbf{u}_E^{n-1})|_{\mathbf{x}_r=\boldsymbol{\xi}(s)} \frac{d\xi^\delta}{ds} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r. \quad (93)$$

In Eq. (93), we have used Eqs. (2) and (5) to rewrite the derivative of $\phi(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s))$.

- **Update D.** Solve for $\mathbf{u}_D^n$ and $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n$ the BVPs given by Eqs. (74) and (77) with BCs (75), (78) and

$$\mathbf{u}_D^n = \mathbf{u}_E^n \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r, \quad (94)$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n = \dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^n \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r. \quad (95)$$

- **Update F.** Solve the BVPs given by (60) and (70) and BCs (61) to (63), (65), (71) and (73) and

$$\mathbf{v}_{Fr} = \dot{\mathbf{u}}_E \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r, \quad (96)$$

which replaces Eq. (65) for a rigid body, and solve Eq. (68).

An example of the coupled dynamics of **F** and **E** is shown in Fig. 5. Here, $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r$ is an ellipse with semi-axes $a = 0.2$ m, $b = 0.1$ m and center located at $\mathbf{x}_r = (0.4 \text{ m}, 0.2 \text{ m})$, and $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r$ has radius $r = 0.0125$ m and center located at $\mathbf{x}_r$. The **E** density and elastic moduli are, respectively, $\rho_E = 10^3$ Kg/m² and $K = \mu = 10$ Kg/sec². The other parameters are the same as in Fig. 2.

III. FLUID AND HELFRICH MEMBRANE

In this Section, we will build on the analysis of Section II, and complexify the structure of the elastic body with which **F** interacts by considering, instead of an elastic material, an **Helfrich membrane (M)** [1, 17].

Both the physical nature and mathematical description of **M** is significantly more complex than that of **E**. First, unlike **E**, **M** has a fluid structure: its material elements can flow both tangentially and normally to it. Such fluid behavior requires an Eulerian description, which then needs to be connected to the Lagrangian description used to describe **D**. Second, **M** is described by fourth-order PDEs [18], which are significantly more complex than the second-order PDEs which describe **E** [12].

Third, the geometrical description of **M** requires fixing an appropriate *gauge*. In fact, a general parametrization of **M** is given by two functions $\mathbf{x}_c^M(x^1)$, both of which depend on the curvilinear coordinate x^1 . However, a single PDE determines the **M** shape [18]. This redundancy is due to the fact that parametrizations with different values of the stretching

$$\nu^2 \equiv \mathbf{e}_1 \cdot \mathbf{e}_1, \quad (97)$$

$$\mathbf{e}_i \equiv \frac{\partial \mathbf{x}_c^M}{\partial x^i}, \quad (98)$$

yield the same shape. The redundancy above may be removed by a gauge fixing, i.e., by adding a constraint on $\mathbf{x}_c^M$, or its derivatives. Two common gauge choices are the Monge [19, 20], or the arc-length parametrization [1], in which one sets

$$\nu = 1. \quad (99)$$

The arc-length gauge has been used to describe, for instance, the steady state for membrane tubules [1]. However, while a static constraint such as (99) is suited to static shapes, it cannot describe the **M** dynamics, such as the one of **M** interacting with **F**. In fact, as **M** is deformed, it will also stretch: as a result, Eq. (99) must be replaced by a time-dependent constraint—see below.

We describe **M** with the Lagrangian approach, along the lines of the description of **D** in Section I and **E** in Section II. The **M** displacement field is

$$\mathbf{u}_M(x^1) \equiv \mathbf{x}_c^M(x^1) - \mathbf{x}_r^M(x^1), \quad (100)$$

where we choose the **r** configuration as a straight line

$$\mathbf{x}_r^M(x^1) \equiv (x^1, h), \quad 0 \leq x^1 \leq L, \quad (101)$$

which is shown in Fig. 6A.

In order to work out the dynamical equations for **M**, let us derive the force exerted by **F** on **M**. The force exerted on the **M** line element dl_c , located at coordinate x^1 , is [5]

$$F_\alpha(x^1) = -\varsigma_{\alpha\beta}^c(\mathbf{x}_c^M(x^1)) \hat{n}^c{}^\gamma(x^1), \quad (102)$$

where the **F** stress tensor is evaluated at the **c** configuration corresponding to x^1 . The components

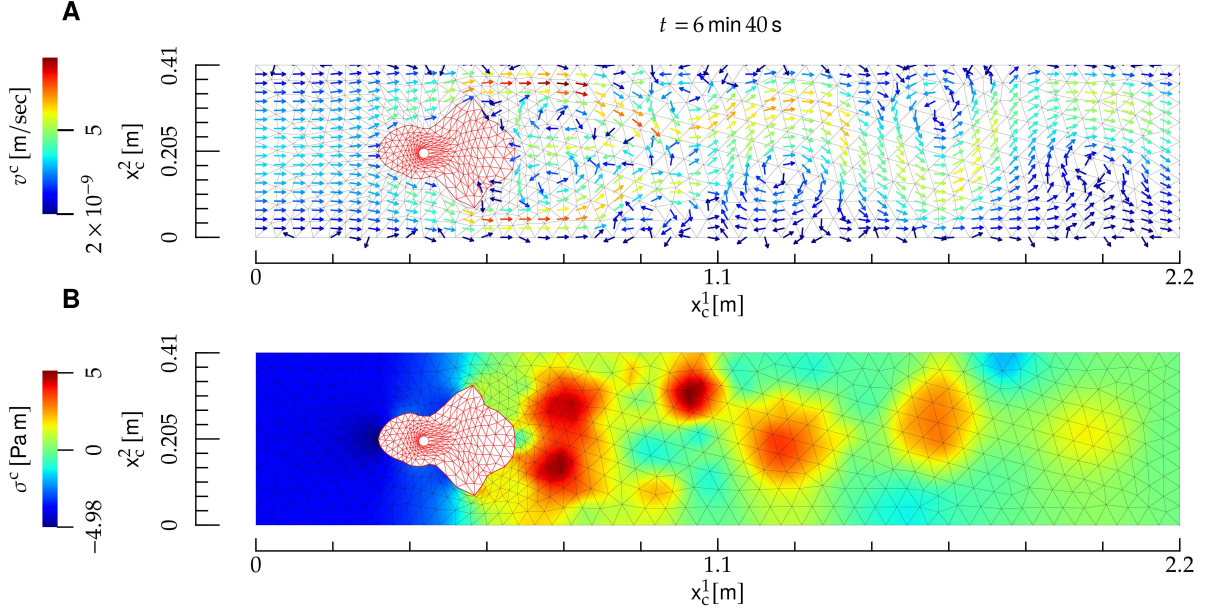


FIG. 5: Interaction between a **bulk fluid** and an **elastic body**. The notation is the same as in Fig. 2, and the **elastic body** is depicted as a red mesh.

of this force tangential and normal to $\mathbf{M}$ are [20]

$$F_t^i = g^{ij} e_j^\alpha F_\alpha \quad (103)$$

$$F_n = \hat{n}^c{}^\alpha F_\alpha, \quad (104)$$

where $g_{ij} \equiv \mathbf{e}_i \cdot \mathbf{e}_j$ is the metric tensor. In what follows, latin indices $i, j, k, \dots$ will be used to denote vectors and tensors related to the $\mathbf{M}$ manifold; their position as upper and lower indexes is thus important [7]. Here,

The equations of motion for $\mathbf{M}$ thus read [12, 21, 22]

$$\nabla_i v^i - 2Hw = 0, \quad (105)$$

$$\rho(\partial_t v^i + v^j \nabla_j v^i - 2v^j w b_j^i - w \nabla^i w) = \nabla^i \sigma + \eta [-\nabla_{\text{LB}} v^i - 2(b^{ij} - 2H g^{ij}) \nabla_j w + 2K v^i] + F_t^i, \quad (106)$$

$$\rho [\partial_t w + v^i (v^j b_{ji} + \nabla_i w)] = -2\kappa [\nabla_i \nabla^i H + 2H(H^2 - K)] + 2\sigma H + 2\eta [(\nabla^i v^j) b_{ij} - 2w(2H^2 - K)] + F_n, \quad (107)$$

mean and Gaussian curvature, respectively,

and they hold for $x^1 \in \partial\Omega_-^r$. Equation (105) enforces mass conservation, and Eqs. (106) and (107) are the tangential and normal components of the **NS** equations, respectively. Also, ∇ is the covariant derivative related to the Levi-Civita connection associated to g , ∇_{LB} the Laplace-Beltrami operator, b the second fundamental form, and H and K the

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

We would like to thank S. Al-Izzi and S. Astruc for useful discussions, and the **finite element computational software (FEniCS)** online community for its precious support.

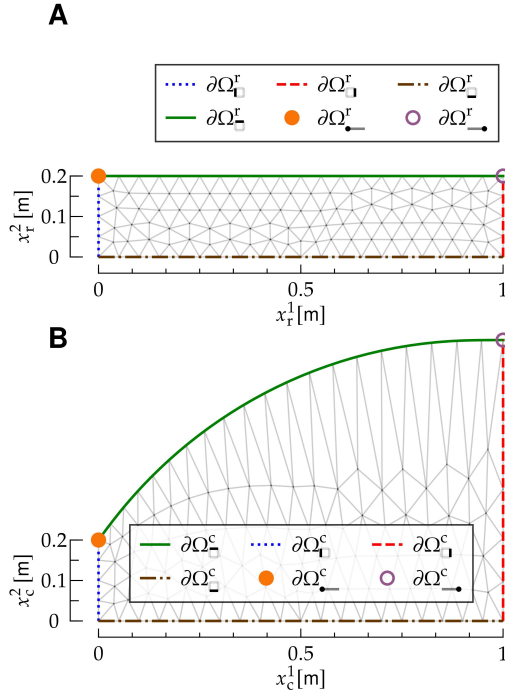


FIG. 6: Reference and current configuration for the interaction between a bulk fluid (F) and a Helfrich membrane (M). The figure follows the same notation as Fig. 1. The top edge of the F mesh, $\partial\Omega_r^f$, coincides with the one-dimensional manifold Ω_r^f of M. In panels A and B, the domains Ω^r and Ω^c are the regions covered by the mesh, respectively.

This work was granted access to the high-performance computing resources of MesoPSL financed by the Region Île de France, and to the Abacus cluster at Institut Curie.

-
- [1] I. Derényi, F. Jülicher, and J. Prost, Formation and Interaction of Membrane Tubes, *Phys. Rev. Lett.* **88**, 238101 (2002).
 - [2] D. Kamensky, Lecture notes for MAE 207: Finite element analysis for coupled problems (2022).
 - [3] L. D. Landau and E. M. Lifshitz, *Theory of Elasticity* (Elsevier, 1986).
 - [4] W. S. Slaughter, *The Linearized Theory of Elasticity* (Birkhäuser Boston, Boston, MA, 2002).
 - [5] L. D. Landau and E. M. Lifshitz, *Fluid Mechanics* (Pergamon, 1987).
 - [6] H. Goldstein, C. P. Poole, and J. L. Safko, *Classical Mechanics* (Pearson, 2004).
 - [7] S. Marchiafava, *Appunti Di Geometria Differenziale*, Vol. I, II, III (Edizioni Nuova Cultura, 2005).
 - [8] A. Logg, K.-A. Mardal, and G. Wells, eds., *Automated Solution of Differential Equations by the Finite Element Method: The FEniCS Book*, Lecture Notes in Computational Science and Engineering, Vol. 84 (Springer Berlin Heidelberg, Berlin, Heidelberg, 2012).
 - [9] J. E. Marsden and T. J. R. Hughes, *Mathematical Foundations of Elasticity* (Dover, New York, 1994).
 - [10] J. Crank and P. Nicolson, A practical method for numerical evaluation of solutions of partial differential equations of the heat-conduction type, *Math. Proc. Camb. Phil. Soc.* **43**, 50 (1947).
 - [11] K. Goda, A multistep technique with implicit difference schemes for calculating two- or three-dimensional cavity flows, *Journal of Computational Physics* **30**, 76 (1979).
 - [12] D. Wörthmüller, G. Ferraro, P. Sens, and M. Castellana, IRENE: A fluid layer finitE-elemeNt softwarE, <http://arxiv.org/abs/2506.17827> (2025), [arXiv:2506.17827](https://arxiv.org/abs/2506.17827) [physics].
 - [13] *Solving Ordinary Differential Equations I*, Springer Series in Computational Mathematics, Vol. 8 (Springer Berlin Heidelberg, Berlin, Heidelberg, 1993).
 - [14] A. J. Chorin, Numerical solution of the Navier-Stokes equations, *Math. Comp.* **22**, 745 (1968).
 - [15] H. Blum, J. Harig., S. Müller, S. Schreiber, and S. Turek, FEAT2D, Finite Element Analysis Tools User Manual (1995).
 - [16] Y. Bazilevs, V. M. Calo, T. J. R. Hughes, and

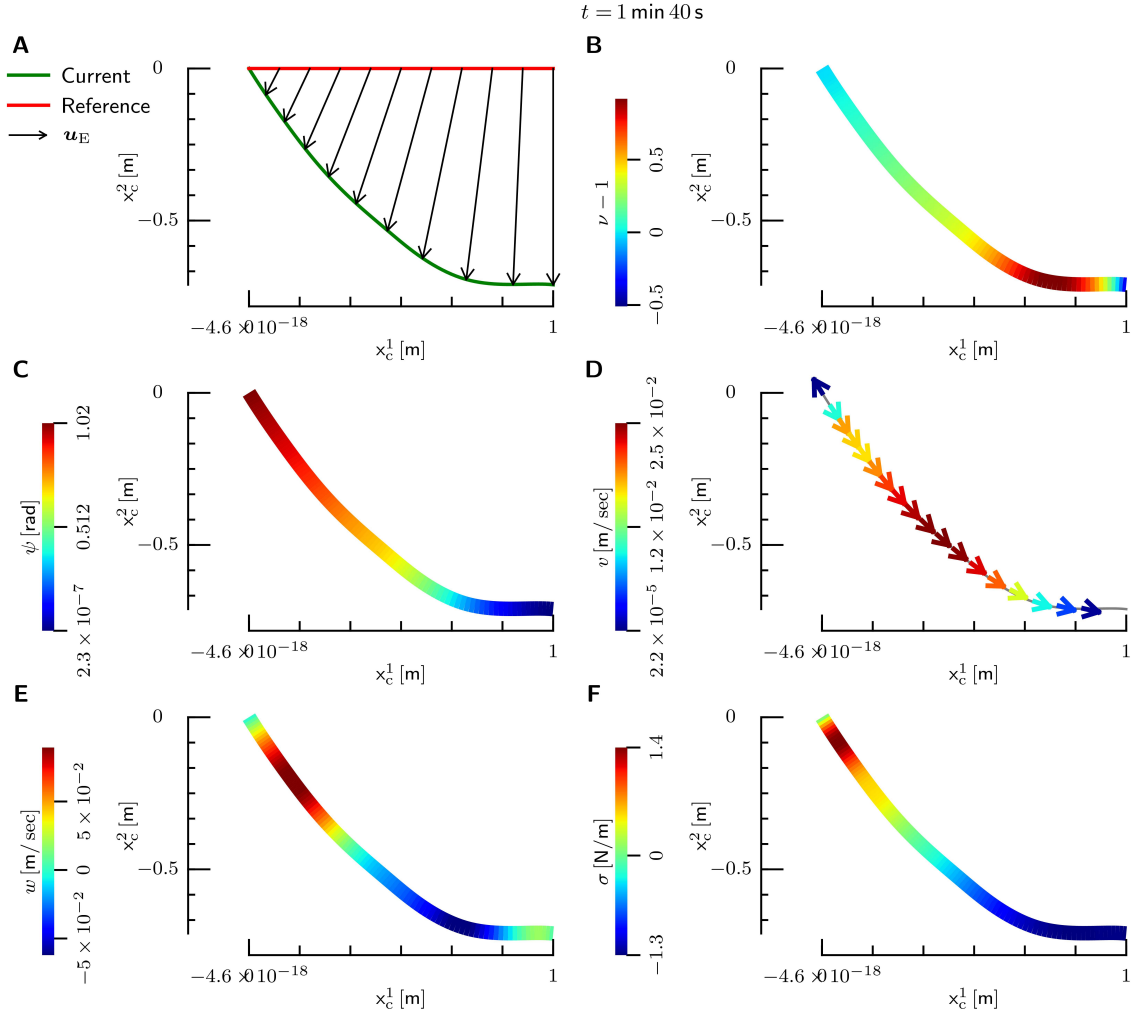


FIG. 7: Helfrich fluid layer described with the generalized **arc length** gauge. The layer is subjected to a gravitational field directed along the X^2 axis, in the direction of negative X^2 . **A**) Displacement field $\vec{U}$, which relates the reference and the current configuration, shown in red and green, respectively. **B**) Stretching ν . **C**) Tangent angle ψ . **D**) Tangential velocity. Arrows show the velocity direction, and the color code the velocity norm. **E**) Normal velocity, whose value is shown with the color code. **F**) Surface tension. All panels refer to the same instant of time, shown on top.

- Y. Zhang, Isogeometric fluid-structure interaction: Theory, algorithms, and computations, *Comput Mech* **43**, 3 (2008).
- [17] W. Helfrich, Elastic Properties of Lipid Bilayers: Theory and Possible Experiments, *Zeitschrift für Naturforschung C* **28**, 693 (1973).
- [18] O.-Y. Zhong-can and W. Helfrich, Bending energy of vesicle membranes: General expressions for the first, second, and third variation of the shape energy and applications to spheres and cylinders, *Phys. Rev. A* **39**, 5280 (1989).
- [19] C.-C. Hsiung, *A First Course in Differential Geometry* (John Wiley & Sons, New York, USA, 1981).
- [20] M. Deserno, Fluid lipid membranes: From differential geometry to curvature stresses, *Chemistry and Physics of Lipids* **185**, 11 (2015).
- [21] S. C. Al-Izzi, P. Sens, and M. S. Turner, Shear-Driven Instabilities of Membrane Tubes and Dynamin-Induced Scission, *Phys. Rev. Lett.* **125**, 018101 (2020).
- [22] M. Arroyo and A. DeSimone, Relaxation dynamics of fluid membranes, *Phys. Rev. E* **79**, 031915 (2009).

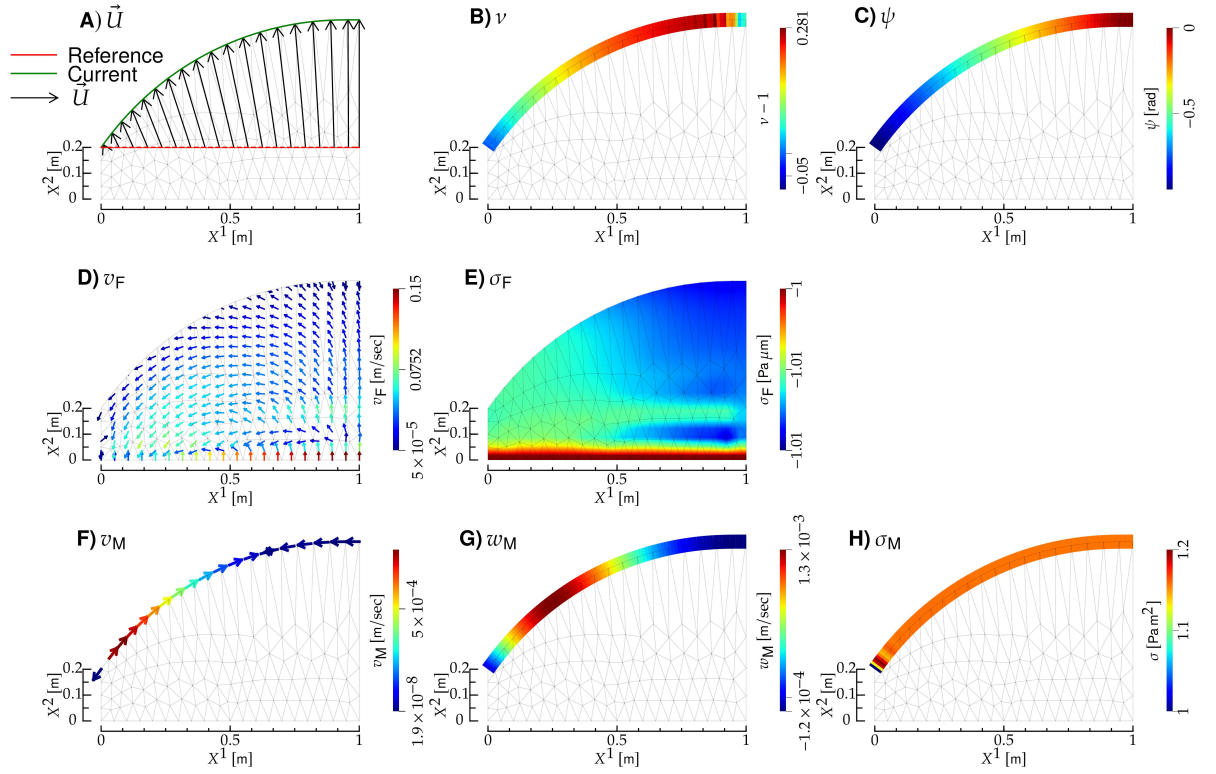


FIG. 8: Interaction between a bulk fluid and a Helfrich membrane. **A)** Membrane reference and current configuration (red and green curve, respectively), and displacement field (black arrows). **B)** Membrane stretch field. **C)** Membrane tangent angle. **D)** and **E)** Bulk-fluid velocity and tension; the notation is the same as in Fig. 2. **F)**, **G)** and **H)** membrane tangential velocity, normal velocity and tension; the notation is the same as in Fig. 7B, C and D, respectively. All panels refer to the same instant of time, shown on top, and display also the deformed mesh (gray lines).